



SIDEROPHOBIA
Fear of stars



CHIONOPHOBIA
Fear of snow



ANABLEPHOBIA
Fear of looking up

UNUSUAL PHOBIAS

Feelings of fear occur below the level of conscious thought, which is why phobias can come from things that people know are not really a threat. More unusual phobias may be tied to a deep-rooted emotional trauma. For some reason, a nonthreatening object or situation takes on the focus of the fear, acting as the spark for pent-up feelings of anxiety. Here are some examples of unusual phobias. Oh, and spare a thought for panaphobics, who are scared of everything!

CATOPTROPHOBIA
Fear of mirrors

AMBULOPHOBIA
Fear of walking

OPTOPHOBIA
Fear of opening your eyes

GENUPHOBIA
Fear of knees

CHRONOMENTROPHOBIA
Fear of time

SCUIROPHOBIA
Fear of squirrels

PELADOPHOBIA
Fear of bald people

OVERCOMING PHOBIAS

People suffering from phobias should not despair. A variety of programs, treatments, and counseling are used to combat fears. One technique is to expose the sufferer to their fear for a prolonged time. High anxiety cannot be maintained, and when it passes, the patient realizes that nothing bad has happened. Some programs aim to replace fear with relaxation. Virtual reality (VR) helmets are used to display an image of what frightens the patient. As they become anxious, the frame is frozen and the patient learns to use relaxation techniques as an alternative response.